

Registrar's Office Curriculum Review Guide (Graduate Programs)

Derived from 2 years of Registrar's Office reviewer comments on graduate program proposals in CourseLeaf CIM (2024-07 -> 2026-07). Source: 2,779 workflow comments across 516 programs; the rules below are the recurring, policy-bearing patterns. Registrar's Office authors: Heather Daly (primary), David Rogers (Banner setup), Mariana De Paula, MJ Boudreault, Benoy Joseph, Christine Cornwall, Melanie Standig, Melissa Couch-Hrinda, Melissa Daigle-Briggs.

How to use this. These are conventions the Registrar's Office applies during review that are not fully published elsewhere. Aligning a proposal to them *before* submission avoids rollbacks and speeds approval. Each rule states the convention and, where useful, why it exists.

1. Effective term & catalog edition

1.1 — The effective catalog edition must match the effective term. A Fall YYYY effective term maps to the YYYY–(YYYY+1) catalog edition.

1.2 — Program-requirement changes take effect on a catalog-year (Fall) basis only. A requirement change cannot be effective mid-year (e.g. Spring); the effective term is moved to the next Fall.

1.3 — There is an annual college-approval deadline per catalog year; miss it and the proposal rolls to the next edition. The Registrar moves the edition forward when the deadline has passed.

1.4 — New degree programs needing Faculty Senate / Board approval may be pushed to a later term/edition, but can be included in a catalog *addendum* if fully approved before publication.

2. Program title & naming

2.1 — Campus-specific program records must carry the campus in the full program title, in parentheses. Per the Registrar's "campus-specific records project."

2.2 — Degree and campus are both reflected in the full program title.

2.3 — Minors do NOT carry a campus parenthetical.

2.4 — Online program titles follow the standard "(Online)" convention. The special "(Online – Vancouver Requirements)" form is a one-off regulatory case and should **not** be used as a model for new online programs.

3. Program overview language

3.1 — Remove implied promises of student achievement / outcomes.

3.2 — Do not imply the curriculum includes remedial or undergraduate coursework.

3.3 — Overview must state whether a concentration is optional or required, consistently with the requirements. If optional, say "optional"; if a single mandatory concentration, integrate it into the text.

3.4 — Overview links for multi-campus programs must point to the network-wide listing, not a single campus.

4. Concentrations

4.1 — If a concentration is not required to complete the program, the heading is not "Concentrations." It becomes "Concentration or Electives Option," and instructions like "Complete one of the following concentrations" are removed.

4.2 — The internal-use "Concentration(s)" field must be populated, including **NOCC (No Concentration)** when none is required, and the "Can students choose this concentration at the time of admission?" flag set consistently across the program's concentrations.

4.3 — Inactive courses inside a concentration must be resolved before approval (proposal is routed back to the college dean's office to fix).

4.4 — Concentration requirements should be consistent across a program's campus deployments (align non-Boston records to the Boston record).

5. Credit hours

5.1 — The catalog publishes only the MINIMUM hours required to complete the program — ranges like "34–35 SH" become "34 SH". Exception: Align/Bridge/Connect programs, which may legitimately require more.

5.2 — Restricted-elective / choice language uses "at least N SH" / "a minimum of N SH," not a range.

5.3 — Remove "maximum of N semester hours" statements. The catalog documents the minimum for completion; students may exceed it where options allow.

5.4 — Credit hours must be semester hours (SH), not quarter hours (QH). QH references are corrected (part of the CPS semester conversion).

5.5 — For "choose N SH from the following" requirements, put the hours in the dedicated hours field and indent the options so credit is associated with the requirement, not shown per-option. Conversely, **core-requirement courses are un-indented** so their hours display.

6. Committee routing (UGCC / UGCC / Graduate Council)

6.1 — Any change to core requirements must be routed to UGCC (graduate).

6.2 — Adding courses from other colleges (or adding/removing a college's course from a UIP) requires UGCC review.

6.3 — A "Course Not Found" error in a curriculum clears once the referenced new course is approved by UGCC — it is not a defect to fix in the program proposal.

6.4 — Online programs do not require GRA review and are routed to the Registrar's degree-audit team instead.

7. Admission, inactivation & teach-out

7.1 — Set "Is this program open for students applying through admissions?" correctly — but note PlusOne students are admitted via Slate, so a program admitting PlusOne students must remain "Yes" even if not open to external applicants.

7.2 — An inactivation proposal is held until its successor new-program proposal is ready; both advance to the same UGCC meeting.

7.3 — The "Final Catalog" field on an inactivation must match the inactivation's effective term. Inactivated as of Fall 2025 -> final catalog 2024-2025 (not 2025-2026).

8. Degree audit, CIP codes & campus/modality

8.1 — CIP code and campus/modality fields are set by the Registrar's degree-audit team on new program records (an administrative step, not a college action).

8.2 — An online program flipping BOS -> Online (VTL) for 2026-2027 is not a genuinely new program, even though CourseLeaf tags it "New Program Proposal" — it's the creation of the VTL-campus record. Registrar adds the Banner program/major code and existing CIP.

8.3 — Dual-degree programs have no degree-audit impact and skip that step.

8.4 — Credit-bearing experiential-learning courses that also satisfy an elective must be listed in the electives list for degree audits to function.

9. Grade / GPA requirements

9.1 — Minimum-grade statements at core requirements use the college's standard wording. For COE: "The College of Engineering requires that students must earn a grade of C or higher in all required core courses..." — added/normalized per college request.

9.2 — Prerequisites outside the program should not be required for core courses. The minimum-grade statement is simplified to "A grade of C or higher is required for each of the following courses."

9.3 — Don't add "prerequisite conditions may require a higher minimum grade" when the program has only one core course (the sentence is dropped as inapplicable).

10. Prerequisites

10.1 — When elective options require prerequisites outside the program, add the standard alert language and ensure there are completion pathways that don't require the external coursework.

11. Experiential learning / co-op

11.1 — If co-op/experiential participation adds hours or tuition, the Program Requirements must alert students.

11.2 — Optional experiential learning is placed in a dedicated "Optional Experiential Learning Opportunities" area (added with college authorization).

11.3 — Non-credit / non-existent co-op prep courses are removed from the curriculum. A line is deleted if the course was never created or awards no credit.

12. Thesis / capstone

12.1 — Zero-credit special-purpose courses (Thesis Continuation, Research) are removed from elective lists — they don't award credit toward the elective hours.

12.2 — A heading offering "Thesis" must reflect what is actually offered — e.g. "Capstone or Thesis" -> "Capstone or Project" when thesis is no longer an option.

12.3 — A thesis sequence that relies on a repeatable course requires that course to be UGCC-approved as repeatable first.

13. Dual / joint degrees

13.1 — Dual-degree programs have no standalone degree-audit impact (see 8.3) but changes to shared credits still go to UGCC.

13.2 — Dual-degree catalog URLs get a redirect established by the Registrar when program pages move.

14. Curriculum-list hygiene

14.1 — No duplicate courses in a list; electives are kept in alphanumeric order.

14.2 — Inactive ("red-boxed") courses must be resolved by the college before approval; the Registrar removes inactive courses from requirement options.

14.3 — Lines for courses that don't exist are removed (phantom courses that were never created).

Companion files: registrar_rules.json (machine-readable checks) and registrar_comments.xlsx (all comments by commenter and program; a Registrar flag column marks the Registrar's Office authors listed above).